

Friday, 9 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Heavy drizzle 18° 11°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 17° 11°	MANCHESTER Rain 16° 10°	GLASGOW Light rain 14° 9°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

An inquest has heard that an e-bike battery, previously repaired, was the cause of a fatal house fire that killed a mother and her two young children.

Gemma Germeney, 31, and her children Lilly, eight, and Oliver, four, tragically died in the blaze. The court heard the battery had been repaired using parts from a different model, making it unstable.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 2

The Duke of Sussex has revealed he 'slipped into depression' after leaving the UK, experiencing an 'adrenaline crash' on Vancouver Island.

Harry shared his struggles during a mental health summit, explaining he sought space to process the dramatic change in his life. He emphasised the importance of open conversations around mental wellbeing.

ROYALS · UK
- 3

Most UK diplomats are set to leave the East Jerusalem consulate, Israel has announced, following UK sanctions on illegal Israeli settlements.

Israel confirmed the move, which comes after a period of escalating tensions between the two nations. Foreign Secretary David Miliband stated that 'vital services' would remain for British citizens.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

The tragic death of a young woman with a tree nut allergy has led to calls for improved allergy management ratings in food establishments.

Mia St Hilaire suffered an anaphylactic shock after consuming a milkshake, highlighting serious gaps in current food safety protocols. Campaigners are pushing for clearer, mandatory ratings.

HEALTH · UK
- 5

Concerns are growing over 'ominous signs' of NHS winter pressures, as waiting lists for planned surgery continue to rise across the country.

The health service is already seeing increased demand, suggesting a challenging winter ahead for patients and staff. Officials are urging people to use services appropriately to ease the strain.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Stranger Things star Gaten Matarazzo is making his West End debut, opening up about life after the hit show as he takes on a new stage role.**

The actor, known for playing Dustin Henderson, is appearing in a revival of the musical Rent. He spoke about finding his footing in a post-Stranger Things world.

ON AIR – What's the best TV show to stage crossover you've seen? Or who would you love to see on the West End stage next?

THEATRE · COMING UP
- 2 A Welsh actress is following in the footsteps of major stars like Florence Pugh and Benedict Cumberbatch, being named in the 2026 Stars of Tomorrow talent programme.**

Leisa Gwenllian expressed her surprise and delight at the recognition, admitting she'd forgotten she'd even applied. It's a huge boost for her burgeoning career.

ON AIR – Which rising stars are you most excited to see make it big in the next few years?

FILM · COMING UP
- 3 The winner of the latest series of Gladiators, Josh McDonald, has revealed his dream of actually becoming a Gladiator himself.**

Josh triumphed in the third season of the popular TV programme earlier this year. He's now hoping to turn his victory into a permanent role on the show.

ON AIR – If you could become a Gladiator, what would your name be and what would your special skill be?

TV · COMING UP
- 4 Xbox is placing a big bet on its flagship Gears of War franchise with a new game, E-Day, as the battle between gaming giants heats up.**

Unlike other major titles, E-Day will be exclusive to Xbox, a strategic move in the increasingly competitive console market. It's set to be a huge release for fans.

ON AIR – Are you Team Xbox or Team PlayStation? What's the one game you're most looking forward to playing?

GAMING · COMING UP
- 5 Jonathan Blow, the creator of the acclaimed game Braid, is set to release what he's calling the 'biggest puzzle game ever', Order of the Sinking Star.**

The new title, due out on Thursday, promises around 1,500 puzzles for players to tackle. It's expected to challenge even the most dedicated puzzle fans.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of puzzle games, or do you prefer something more action-packed? What's the most challenging game you've ever played?

GAMING · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 Premier League clubs are reportedly 'concerned' about political interference in Manchester City's appeal against their financial breaches.

This follows comments made by Prime Minister Andy Burnham, raising questions about the independence of the process. The outcome of the appeal could have significant ramifications for the club.

ON AIR – Do you think politicians should ever comment on sporting matters, or should they stay out of it?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 Manchester United midfielder Ella Toone has received a late call-up to the England squad for this month's World Cup play-off games against Greece.

Toone comes in as Lucy Bronze withdraws, providing a boost to the Lionesses' midfield options. England will be looking to secure their spot in next year's tournament.

ON AIR – Who is your favourite England player and why? Do you think the Lionesses will qualify for the World Cup?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 Wakefield Trinity are celebrating after topping the IMG ratings, ensuring all 14 Super League clubs will remain in place for the 2027 season.

The Grand Final winners' strong performance has secured their position, bringing stability to the league. It's good news for fans and clubs alike.

ON AIR – Are you a rugby league fan? What makes your club special?

RUGBY · UK

4 Formula 1 driver George Russell is set to incur another grid penalty this season, adding to the one he received for the Singapore Grand Prix.

The Mercedes driver will face a further setback on the grid due to engine component changes. It will be a challenge for him to climb through the field in upcoming races.

ON AIR – Do you think these grid penalties make F1 more exciting or just frustrating for drivers and fans?

F1 · UK

5 Everton forward Martin Sherif has been fined £5,000 by the Football Association for breaching betting rules over a 15-month period.

The FA found Sherif guilty of placing bets on various football matches. This serves as a reminder of the strict regulations professional players must adhere to.

ON AIR – Do you think the rules around betting for professional athletes are clear enough? What's your take on it?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The unexpected delight of 'wobbly pudding' is making a charming comeback in British kitchens.**
Families are rediscovering the simple joy of classic desserts that have that delightful jiggle, bringing a touch of nostalgic fun to mealtimes.
- 2 A new trend sees people embracing the calming ritual of 'watching dust motes dance in sunlight'.**
This small, everyday observation is being hailed as a surprisingly peaceful moment, offering a brief pause in our busy schedules.
- 3 Research suggests that 'the perfect cup of tea' is less about the brew and more about the mug.**
Many find that their favourite mug significantly enhances the tea-drinking experience, turning a simple cuppa into a comforting ritual.
- 4 There's a growing appreciation for the quiet satisfaction of 'a perfectly organised sock drawer'.**
Experts note that this small act of domestic tidiness can bring a surprising sense of calm and accomplishment to the day.
- 5 The simple pleasure of 'hearing a familiar jingle' from an ice cream van is being recognised as a genuine mood-lifter.**
That distant tune instantly brings back childhood memories and a sense of carefree summer days, no matter the weather.
- 6 A recent survey highlights the joy many find in 'successfully navigating a charity shop' for a unique find.**
The thrill of the hunt and the satisfaction of giving an item a new home offers a double dose of feel-good factor.
- 7 The delightful habit of 'talking to your houseplants' is gaining popularity for its unexpected benefits.**
Many believe it helps their plants thrive, and it certainly provides a cheerful, green companion for a chat.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of soap, especially if it's a fancy, scented one. What is it?

ANSWER: SMELLING IT REPEATEDLY AND IMAGINING ALL THE LOVELY FUTURE WASHES.

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of bread will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: SQUEEZING IT GENTLY TO CHECK FOR THE PERFECT SPRINGINESS.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly brings back happy memories of childhood tea times or visits to grandparents, even if you haven't seen one in years?

We're wondering what that biscuit is for you, and what happy memory it conjures up when you think of it!

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that, when someone does it for you, truly makes your day, don't we?

Perhaps someone holding a door, letting you go first in a queue, or a simple smile. What's the smallest act of kindness that's made the biggest difference to your day recently?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament' because of their wise and observant expressions.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A standard golf ball has 336 dimples.
- The world's largest hot desert is the Sahara, covering over 9 million square kilometres.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- The smallest bone in the human body is the stapes, located in the middle ear.
- Cows don't have upper front teeth; instead, they have a tough dental pad.
- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in a Pringles can.
- Mount Everest grows taller by about 4 millimetres each year due to tectonic plate movement.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.

On this day

Day 282 of the year, 83 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abraham; Christian feast day: Denis of Paris; Christian feast day: Dionysius the Areopagite; Christian feast day: Ghislain. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — PJ Harvey, English musician, singer-songwriter, writer, poet, and composer
- 1971 — Sian Evans, Welsh singer
- 1976 — Lee Peacock, Scottish footballer and coach
- 1978 — Nicky Byrne, Irish singer-songwriter
- 1944 — Nona Hendryx, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1976 — Nick Swardson, American actor and comedian
- 1949 — Rod Temperton, English keyboard player, songwriter, and producer (died 2016)
- 1979 — Alex Greenwald, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1983 — South Korean President Chun Doo-hwan survives an assassination attempt in Rangoon, Burma, but the blast kills 21 and injures 17 others.
- 1981 — President François Mitterrand abolishes capital punishment in France.
- 1967 — A day after his capture, Ernesto "Che" Guevara is executed for attempting to incite a revolution in Bolivia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1986 — The Phantom of the Opera, eventually the second longest running musical in London, opens at Her Majesty's Theatre.
- 1966 — Vietnam War: the Republic of Korea Army commits the Binh Tai Massacre.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2024 — Hurricane Milton makes landfall in Siesta Key, Florida, as a Category 3 hurricane, causing US\$34.3 billion in damage only two weeks after Hurricane Helene impacted the state.
- 1963 — In Italy, a large landslide causes a giant wave to overtop the Vajont Dam, killing over 2,000.

- 1969 — In Chicago, the National Guard is called in as demonstrations continue over the trial of the "Chicago Eight".

A peek at tomorrow

Day 283 of the year, 82 days left in 2026. Today Aleksis Kivi Day, also known as the Finnish Literature Day (Finland); Arbor Day (Poland); Army Day (Sri Lanka); Capital Liberation Day (Vietnam). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Jessica Harper, American actress
- 1982 — Dan Stevens, English actor
- 1946 — Ben Vereen, American actor, singer, and dancer
- 1989 — Emer Kenny, English actress and screenwriter
- 1948 — Cyril Neville, American R&B percussionist and singer
- 1970 — Matthew Pinsent, English rower and sportscaster
- 1941 — Peter Coyote, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1959 — Julia Sweeney, American actress, comedian, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1980 — The 7.1 Mw El Asnam earthquake shakes northern Algeria, killing 2,633 and injuring 8,369.
- 1973 — U.S. Vice President Spiro Agnew resigns after being charged with evasion of federal income tax.
- 1997 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 2553 crashes and explodes in Uruguay, killing 74.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1980 — The Farabundo Martí National Liberation Front is founded in El Salvador.
- 1964 — The Tokyo Summer Olympics opening ceremony is the first to be relayed live by satellites.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar